

Results

01 · PATH ANALYSIS

directed relationships among observed variables (path / mediation models)

Table 1. Structural paths

Path	B	SE	z	p	Std. β	95% CI	R²
esg_score → norm_score	−0.10	0.05	−1.93	.054	−.10	[−.20, .00]	.01
norm_score → intent_score	0.25	0.05	5.30	<.001	.26	[.17, .35]	.17
esg_score → intent_score	0.35	0.04	7.82	<.001	.34	[.26, .42]	.17

Table 2. Indirect effects

Path	Estimate	SE	boot 95% CI	p
esg_score → norm_score → intent_score	−0.03	0.01	[-0.06, -0.00]	.077

Saturation: The model is saturated (df = 0): it has zero degrees of freedom, so global fit indices are not informative and are suppressed. Estimated paths and effects below are still interpretable.

Figure. Path diagram

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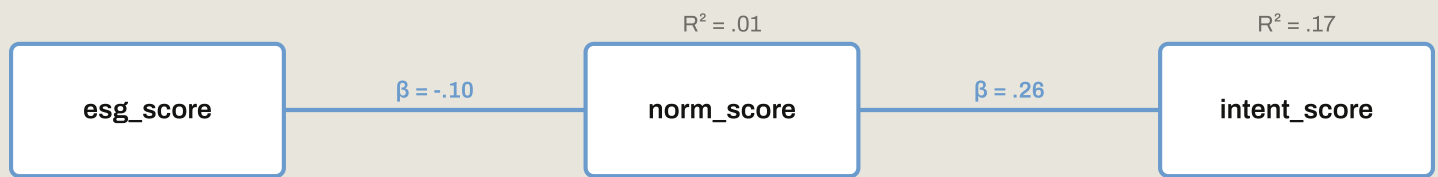
+

Fit

Draw path

Move

Delete



Understanding the numbers

B. The unstandardized structural-path estimate: the raw-unit effect of one variable on another. Here, path B's range from -0.10 to 0.35 across the 3 structural paths.

SE. The standard error of a structural-path or indirect-effect estimate. Here, SEs range from 0.01 to 0.05 across the structural and indirect-effect rows.

z. A structural path's estimate divided by its SE. Here, z-values range from -1.93 to 7.82 across the 3 structural paths.

p. The significance of a structural-path or indirect-effect estimate. Here, p-values range from $<.001$ to $.077$ across the structural and indirect-effect rows.

Std. β . The standardized structural-path effect, comparable across paths regardless of each variable's own units. Here, standardized path coefficients range from $-.10$ to $.34$ across the 3 paths.

95% CI. The confidence interval for a structural path's estimate, or the bootstrap 95% CI for an indirect effect. Here, each structural path has its own 95% CI, and each indirect effect its own bootstrap 95% CI (see the tables above) - an interval excluding 0 indicates a credible effect.

R². The variance explained in each endogenous (outcome) variable. Here, R² ranges from $.01$ to $.17$ across the 3 paths.

Estimate. The size of an indirect (mediated) effect - the product of the paths through a mediator. Here, indirect-effect estimates range from -0.03 to -0.03 across the 1 mediation chain(s).

How to read this test

Path analysis estimates a system of regressions among observed variables at once, letting one variable be both an outcome and a predictor (mediation). Structural paths: each B is the unstandardized effect, Std. β the standardized effect,

with z, p, and a 95% CI; R^2 is the variance explained in each endogenous variable. Indirect effects: the product of the paths through a mediator (e.g. $X \rightarrow M \rightarrow Y$), judged by its bootstrap 95% CI - an interval excluding 0 indicates mediation. When $df = 0$ the model is saturated (it reproduces the data exactly), so fit indices are not informative and are omitted; only with extra constraints ($df > 0$) do global fit indices apply, and even then read RMSEA cautiously at small df / small N . All thresholds are heuristics, not pass/fail gates.

APA template: A path model fit to the observed variables; the indirect effect of X on Y through M was significant, bootstrap 95% CI excluding 0. Estimated with maximum likelihood.

Statistical basis: Path model estimation (lavaan::sem, observed variables only) (Rosseel, Y. (2012). "lavaan: An R Package for Structural Equation Modeling." Journal of Statistical Software, 48(2), 1-36.); RMSEA interpreted cautiously at small df / small N for over-identified models (Kenny, D. A., Kaniskan, B., McCoach, D. B. (2015). "The performance of RMSEA in models with small degrees of freedom." Sociological Methods & Research, 44(3), 486-507.); Bootstrap percentile CIs for indirect (mediated) effects (MacKinnon, D. P., Lockwood, C. M., Williams, J. (2004). "Confidence limits for the indirect effect: Distribution of the product and resampling methods." Multivariate Behavioral Research, 39(1), 99-128.). Full references in the exported CITATIONS.txt.

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